

short setup note before the call: place the camera at eye level, face a window or lamp, wear headphones, avoid sitting with a bright window behind you, and keep the device connected to power.

If your recording platform can capture local high-quality tracks for each participant, use that rather than relying only on the compressed call feed. Riverside, for example, defines each participant track as the local recording of that individual and maintains separate tracks inside a recording. Ask guests not to close the browser or app until their local upload has finished. For important interviews, retain the conventional audio backup as well.

The remote picture may occasionally soften or freeze, but strong local audio can still preserve the episode for listeners and provide a usable fallback for the edit.

Never trust camera audio as your master

A microphone mounted several feet away still hears the room, regardless of how expensive the camera is.

Record the podcast using the close microphones and workflow established in Chapters 5 and 6. Treat the camera microphone mainly as a reference track for synchronisation.

During editing, align the high-quality audio with the camera footage. Zoom in on the clap waveform, line up the peaks and then mute the camera audio.

Check synchronisation near the beginning, middle and end. Long recordings made on different devices can occasionally drift. If lips gradually stop matching words, correct the drift before making hundreds of camera cuts.

Light faces before decorating the set

Good lighting can make an ordinary smartphone look significantly better. Start with a large window. Position the presenter facing it or at roughly a 45-degree angle instead of sitting with the window directly behind them.



For consistent night-time recording, use a soft LED light slightly above eye level and about 30–45 degrees to one side. If shadows are harsh, use a weaker fill light, a white wall or a reflector on the opposite side.

Keep colour temperatures reasonably consistent. Mixing cool daylight with warm household bulbs can make skin tones difficult to correct. A small background lamp can add separation without turning the set into an electronics showroom.

Build a background that supports the show

Your set should suggest the show's identity without distracting from the speaker. A technology podcast might include a few relevant devices; a books podcast can use shelves; a business programme may suit a clean office.

Before recording, scan the frame for dangling cables, reflective screens, confidential documents, distracting brand logos and personal photographs you do not intend to publish.

Move the subject away from the wall when possible. That physical depth creates separation even without artificial background blur.

Edit camera shots with meaning

Multicamera editing is not a competition to switch angles every five seconds. Changes should help viewers follow the conversation.

Cut to the speaker, but occasionally stay on the listener when their reaction matters. Use the wide shot when both people laugh, interrupt or interact. Avoid cutting mid-blink when another clean angle is available.

A simple interview rhythm is:

- Wide shot for the opening.
- Host close-up for the question.
- Guest close-up for the answer.
- Host reaction when useful.
- Wide shot during overlapping conversation.
- Close-up for an important statement.

If your editor supports a multicam timeline, synchronise all angles first and then switch cameras while playing the conversation. This is faster than manually stacking and trimming each camera for an hour-long interview.

Make graphics earn their screen time

Use graphics to explain, identify or orient. A lower-third can introduce a guest. A chapter card can mark a new section. On-screen text can reinforce an important number. Product images, maps, screenshots and charts help when directly relevant.

If you show something essential, explain it verbally. Instead of “Look at this chart,” say what the chart shows. This preserves meaning for audio-only listeners.

That matters because platforms increasingly permit movement between listening and watching. Apple's HLS implementation lets users switch between video and audio-only playback during an episode, while YouTube podcast videos can also support audio-only playback.